



1868

MEIJI RESTORATION

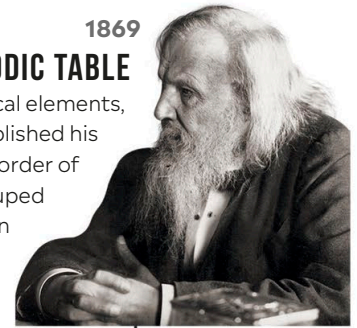
In 1868, a group of ambitious young samurai gathered at the imperial court in Kyoto planning to wrest power from the Tokugawa Shogunate and restore the Emperor's authority. Following victory in the Boshin War between the imperial army and reactionary forces, the young Meiji ("enlightened rule") Emperor oversaw reforms that transformed Japan from an isolationist, feudal country into a modern industrial nation.

△ Mutsuhito, Meiji emperor, 1867-1912

1869

MENDELEEV CREATES THE PERIODIC TABLE

Seeking a way to organize the known chemical elements, Russian chemist Dmitri Mendeleev published his periodic table. He arranged the elements in order of increasing relative atomic mass and grouped those with similar properties. Noting trends in the properties of elements, he left gaps for undiscovered elements, predicting what characteristics they would have.



△ Dmitri Mendeleev

1869

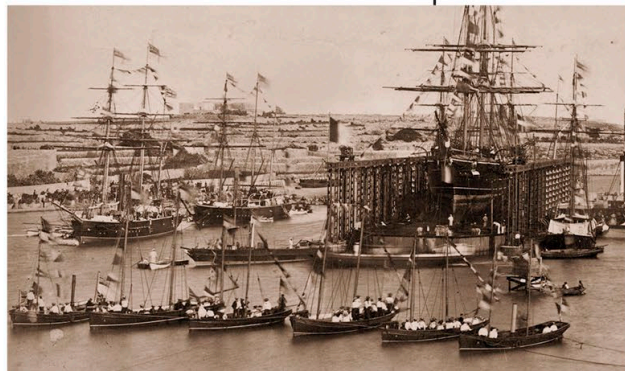
1867 The British Dominion of Canada is created from the provinces of Canada, Nova Scotia, and New Brunswick

1868 Cuba begins the "Ten Years' War" (1868-78) for independence from Spain



1815-98
OTTO VON BISMARCK

Architect of the German Empire, Bismarck (nicknamed the "Iron Chancellor") led Germany in a period of industrialization, social reform, and colonization before being forced to resign in 1890.



△ Suez Canal opening ceremony

1869

SUEZ CANAL OPENS

The Suez Canal linking the Mediterranean and Red seas was opened - four years behind schedule - on 17 November 1869. After Christian and Muslim blessings at Port Said the French imperial yacht, *L'Aigle* led a procession of ships through the canal. On the first night, the French ship *Péluse* grounded at the entrance to Lake Timsah, where the ships were to anchor for more celebrations.